



COMPETITIVE ANALYSIS

Taxually vs. BEACON

Where the incumbent wins, where a NL-corridor wedge is defensible, and what would have to be true.

Prepared June 2026 · engineering & product research, not legal advice

Where Taxually sits, where BEACON (as scoped across this project — the NL-centred, synthesis-led wedge with the obligations configurator and the guided dashboard) is genuinely differentiated, and where Taxually simply beats us today. Researched June 2026 from Taxually/Stripe primary sources and reviews; uncertainty flagged. Not legal or investment advice.

Premise correction up front. A working assumption going in was that Taxually had rolled up several VAT firms (LOVAT, Counto, Taxmen). That's wrong: ****LOVAT is an independent competitor**** (Edinburgh), and Counto/Taxmen show no link. The **only confirmed acquisition is LumaTax (US sales tax, April 2023)**. And a second correction to our own earlier research: Taxually **does** cover EPR/Verpackungsgesetz (its **EcoTax** module), so bundling EPR is *not*, by itself, our wedge.

Snapshot, side by side

	Taxually	BEACON (as scoped here)
Shape	Horizontal, global VAT/sales-tax compliance platform + managed filing	Vertical wedge: NL-based commerce SMEs expanding to DE & BE
Founded / base	2018, Budapest; ex-KPMG founders; Ardian minority stake (2022)	New entrant (this project)
Coverage	100+ filing jurisdictions (claims vary 50+/100+/150+); EU + UK + US (via LumaTax)	Three markets, deliberately: NL (home), DE, BE
Model	Hybrid software + humans who register & file for you	Synthesis + guided execution; "you stay seller of record, we run the tax"
Distribution	Platform-embedded — Stripe Tax's non-US registration/filing partner	Direct, demand-led on the "synthesis gap"
Adjacent obligations	VAT, OSS/I OSS, EPR (EcoTax) , US sales tax (LumaTax), payments (OneTax)	VAT/OSS + EPR as <i>sequenced</i> steps, NL->DE/BE only
Pricing	Quote-led, opaque; sometimes bundled into Stripe Tax	(Intended) fixed, transparent corridor pricing
Public API	None found publicly; integration is via the Stripe app	(Intended differentiator — but constrained, see §7)
Reputation	Trustpilot ~4.1, polarized: praise + serious registration-delay/"sales-then-silence" complaints	n/a (pre-launch)

1. Strategy — horizontal roll-up vs. vertical wedge

Taxually is a **breadth** play: be the compliance engine for *everywhere*, across VAT, EPR, and US sales tax, and grow by distribution and acquisition. The four-brand structure (CrossTax / LumaTax / EcoTax / OneTax) and the Ardian "external growth" mandate are consistent with that.

BEACON, as we've built it, is the opposite bet: **depth on one corridor**. The whole project — the editorial landing page, the obligations configurator, the Bloomwell dashboard sequenced around Finanzamt Kleve — is designed to be *unmistakably* about "a Dutch shop's first step into Germany/Belgium," not "tax, anywhere."

The strategic question this raises: a vertical wedge only wins if the corridor has **depth Taxually's generic breadth doesn't reach** — Dutch-language handholding, the exact NL->DE sequence, the FBA-stock-in-Germany trigger, LUCID timing. That depth is plausible but **unproven**; breadth is a real, defensible asset for Taxually.

2. Distribution — the Stripe moat is the biggest single fact

Taxually is **Stripe Tax's partner for registering and filing outside the US** (Stripe's own words). For a Stripe merchant, "Register for me" -> Taxually is the *in-dashboard default*, with two-way sync back into Stripe Tax. That's an enormous, low-CAC funnel a new entrant cannot displace head-on.

Two honest implications:

- **We should not try to out-Stripe Stripe.** Much of Taxually's SME inflow is

Stripe merchants, captured at the moment of need inside a product they already use.

- **But Stripe Tax is calculation-first**, and the Taxually flow is self-serve "upload

docs, we submit." That leaves the **guided, sequenced, "what do I do first and by when"** experience underserved — which is exactly what our configurator + dashboard are. The opening is the *non-Stripe-native* SME and the *first-timer who needs a hand*, not the Stripe merchant who just wants a filing done.

3. Product & experience — managed filing vs. sequenced guidance

Taxually genuinely **registers and files** (IOSS intermediary, UK MTD, OSS, multi-country returns) — it is not a calculator. Data sync and return generation are automated; registration review and submission are human. Its product surface is organised by *module* (CrossTax, EcoTax...), i.e. by **obligation type**.

What we've built is organised by **the customer's journey**, not the obligation type:

- **The configurator** turns "where do you sell / where's your stock / are you over

€10k" into the *specific, ordered* obligation map — the synthesis no portal (or Taxually's module list) hands you.

- **The dashboard** shows that as a *timeline with status* — Finanzamt Kleve submitted,

ELSTER pending, LUCID before first sale, first Umsatzsteuervoranmeldung scheduled — plus "needs you" tasks and monitoring.

This is the crux: Taxually answers "*file my returns.*" We're answering "*tell me what this expansion actually requires, in order, and walk me through it.*" Different jobs. The risk is that for a sophisticated seller the second job collapses into the first once they've done it once.

4. Adjacent obligations — our earlier EPR claim needs walking back

Our RESEARCH.md white-space note implied almost nobody bundles VAT + OSS + EPR. **Taxually's EcoTax disproves the strong version of that.** So the differentiator is

not "we also do Verpackungsgesetz." It's narrower and more defensible:

****weaving VAT + OSS + EPR into one sequenced SME flow**** where LUCID appears as "step 8, before your first German sale," rather than as a separate module the seller has to know to buy. Existence of coverage ≠ integrated sequencing. We should market the *sequencing*, not the *coverage*.

5. Trust & onboarding — their weakness is our entire thesis

The most striking finding is that Taxually's pain is **execution and communication, not features**: recurring reviews cite "*sales team disappears after payment*," multi-month-to-multi-year registration delays, lost files, and surprise billing (Trustpilot ~4.1 but polarized). This is the same pattern our RESEARCH.md found across the whole category.

That is precisely the wedge the BEACON experience is built around — **visible status, proactive deadlines, "we chase the Finanzamt for you," and a sequenced plan that tells a first-timer what's next**. If we can deliver *reliable, communicative execution* with an SLA on first registration, that beats "more dashboards" — and it's the one area where a focused newcomer can credibly out-operate a high-volume incumbent.

The catch (see §8): execution reliability is *operational*, and Taxually has already built the filing machinery and authorisations. Claiming we'll execute better is easy; proving it pre-launch is not.

6. Pricing & transparency

Taxually is **quote-led**, with no public price list and **inconsistent self-reported country counts (50+/100+/150+)**. For a first-time NL SME, opacity is friction. A **fixed, transparent NL->DE/BE package** ("here's the price to get compliant in Germany, all-in") is a clean, honest contrast — and cheap to deliver because the corridor is narrow and the steps are known.

7. Tech / API — and the integration-constraint reality check

No public Taxually API/developer docs were found; their "integration" story is mainly the Stripe app. "Open API for NL accounting/marketplace tools" is therefore a *possible* differentiator — **but our own integrations research is a reality check on how far "API-first" can go**:

- **DE filing is ERiC only** (a native library you embed; no REST), and ****preparing**

returns on behalf is reserved to Steuerberater under the StBerG.**

- **NL needs PKI-overheid certs + eHerkenning chain mandates; OSS is portal-bound.**
- **BE** only opened Intervat/MyMinfin APIs in 2025, behind a "recognized user" process.

So nobody — Taxually included — gets a clean API-first path to *government* filing; the moat is operational (authorisations, ERiC integration, a Steuerberater relationship). Where an open API *does* differentiate is on the **input side**: pulling **Amazon SP-API FBA-inventory-by-country** to detect the stock-location trigger, plus Shopify/Stripe — turning our configurator's static logic into *live* monitoring. That's a credible, buildable technical edge that plays to the corridor story.

8. Where Taxually genuinely beats us today (no spin)

- 1 **It actually files, in 100+ jurisdictions** — real, working registration/filing

machinery and IOSS-intermediary status. We have a design, not a filing engine.

- 1 **The Stripe distribution moat** — default in-dashboard funnel, low CAC.

- 2 **Breadth as a retention story** — when the SME later goes beyond DE/BE, Taxually

already covers it; our deliberate narrowness means we'd hand that customer off.

- 1 **EPR + US already covered** (EcoTax, LumaTax) — so several "we also do X" pitches

don't land against them.

1 Operational authorisations already solved — the StBerG/ERiC/eHerkenning hurdles

that we'd have to clear, they've cleared.

9. The defensible wedge for BEACON

Stack-ranked, what actually holds up against Taxually:

1 Sequenced, guided first-expansion experience for the NL->DE/BE corridor — the

configurator + dashboard journey, not a module list. *(Strong; this is the product.)*

1 Reliable, communicative execution with a first-registration SLA — attacking

Taxually's single biggest complaint. *(Strong, but operational to prove.)*

1 Transparent fixed corridor pricing. *(Easy win on friction.)*

2 Live stock-location/threshold monitoring via Amazon SP-API + Shopify. **(Real*

technical edge on the input side.)*

1 Dutch-language, NL-corridor depth (Finanzamt Kleve nuance, BE local quirks).

(Plausible; verify it's real depth, not just claimed.)

What is **not** a wedge: "we do EPR," "we do OSS," "we file returns" — table stakes Taxually already meets.

10. Risks & what would need to be true

- **Job collapses on repeat.** Sequencing is most valuable the *first* time; a seller

who's expanded once may just want cheap filing — where Taxually/Stripe win. Mitigate by making the recurring monitoring/filing genuinely better, not just the onboarding.

- **Operational debt.** Out-executing an incumbent on registrations means building (or

partnering for) the ERiC integration, the eHerkenning mandates, and a Steuerberater relationship — the unglamorous moat. The strategy is only real if we commit to this.

- **Distribution.** Without a Stripe-grade funnel, CAC is the existential risk for a

vertical wedge; the corridor focus has to translate into sharp, cheap demand-gen (NL e-commerce communities, Amazon-FBA NL sellers, accountants).

- **Narrowness as a ceiling.** The wedge is a start; the "SME growth/expansion platform"

vision needs a credible path from one corridor to many without becoming a thinner Taxually.

Scorecard

Dimension	Taxually	BEACON (scoped)	Edge
Breadth of coverage	Strong	Narrow by design	Taxually
Files/registers today	Yes, proven	Design only	Taxually

Dimension	Taxually	BEACON (scoped)	Edge
Distribution	Stripe moat	TBD	Taxually
Guided first-expansion UX	Weak (self-serve)	Strong (configurator + dashboard)	BEACON
Execution reliability / comms	Weak (top complaint)	Thesis (unproven)	BEACON if delivered
Pricing transparency	Opaque	Fixed/transparent	BEACON
EPR / adjacent obligations	Covered (EcoTax)	Covered, <i>sequenced</i>	Tie (edge on sequencing)
NL/BE corridor depth	Generic	Deliberate	BEACON if real
Input-side data integration	Limited public API	SP-API stock trigger	BEACON if built
Operational authorisations	Solved	To build	Taxually

Bottom line. Taxually wins on breadth, distribution, and the fact that it actually works at scale today. BEACON's defensible space is *not* features or coverage — it's the **guided, sequenced, reliably-executed first expansion on one corridor, priced transparently, with live stock-trigger monitoring**. That's a real wedge against Taxually's documented weakness (post-sale execution), provided we treat the unglamorous operational moat — authorisations, ERiC, a Steuerberater partner, a cheap NL funnel — as the actual product, not an afterthought.

Sources (selected)

Taxually: taxually.com (home, about-us, crosstax, onetax, stripe); support.taxually.com (coverage; EPR). Stripe: docs.stripe.com/tax (use-taxually-to-register; file-with-taxually; filing); stripe.com/tax. Corporate: ardian.com (minority-stake press release & feature); pitchbook.com Taxually profile. LumaTax: prnewswire.com & finsmes.com (April 2023 acquisition); taxually.com blog. Reputation: trustpilot.com/review/taxually.com; Amazon Seller Central EU forum thread; glassdoor.com. Comparisons (lower confidence): goodvat.com (Stripe Tax vs Taxually); trykintsugi.com. LOVAT (independent, not acquired): vatcompliance.co / lovat.io. Cross-referenced with this project's own RESEARCH.md and INTEGRATIONS.md.